

FAQ & Troubleshooting

FAQ

What is this platform for?

It is a read-only CVD knowledge platform: diseases are presented as standardized entries (symptoms, risk factors, prevention guidance) with attribution to sources. It is intended for education and exploration.

Is it medical advice?

No. It does not replace professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

Q: What data does the platform store about me?

A: In the MVP, the platform is designed to avoid collecting personal health information (PHI) and personally identifiable information (PII). It focuses on read-only reference content (diseases, symptoms, risk factors, sources) and system telemetry (logs/metrics) for reliability.

Q: What content can I expect to see?

A: You can expect disease reference entries with structured symptom/risk-factor lists and prevention text. You may also see ?Research Cards? (view-only research summaries) depending on the current UI wiring.

Q: Which languages are supported?

A: The backend data model supports English and Russian locales (en, ru). If the UI exposes a language switch, it will typically map to the backend locale parameter; otherwise developers can still request a locale through the API.

Account & Access

Q: Do I need an account to use the platform?

A: Not for the current MVP read-only scope. There is no login/registration requirement for browsing content.

Q: Why can't I access the application or some pages?

A: If you are running locally, the most common causes are that the backend/API is not running, the frontend dev server is not running, or the intended routes are not fully wired in the current build. Verify the services are up and check that the frontend points to the correct API base URL.

Features

Q: How do I search diseases?

A: The API supports free-text search (via a search query parameter) and filtering (e.g., by symptom or risk factor). In the UI, this is typically exposed as a search input and/or filters; if you are integrating directly, call the diseases endpoint with the relevant query parameters.

Q: Why do I sometimes get "No disease found." but the request is successful?

A: Some list endpoints intentionally return HTTP 200 with a JSON { "message": "No disease found." } (or { "message": "No source found." }) when a query returns no results. This is a "no-results" response, not an error.

Q: What are "primary" vs "secondary" factors?

A: The project's data model separates core/primary symptoms from secondary symptom-related factors to keep disease cards readable and to support more structured filtering and analysis.

Q: Where does the content come from?

A: The platform stores and displays a list of official or curated sources (organizations/datasets) and links out to them. In the backend, these appear as "Sources" with a name and a URL.

Q (Developer): What endpoints are available?

A: The backend exposes read-only endpoints under /api, including health checks, diseases, symptoms, risk factors, and sources. See the API reference at [appendices/api-reference.md](#) and Swagger at <http://localhost:4000/api-docs> when running locally.

Q (Developer): What ports does the local setup use?

A: Common defaults are:

- * Backend API: <http://localhost:4000/api>
- * Swagger UI: <http://localhost:4000/api-docs>
- * Frontend dev server (Vite): typically <http://localhost:5173>

Your local .env / Docker Compose configuration is the source of truth.

Q (Developer): How do I run everything locally?

A: The project supports Docker Compose for a full local environment (API + PostgreSQL + Redis). Alternatively, you can run backend and frontend separately with `npm run dev` in each package.

Q (Developer): How do I reset/reseed the database?

A: From the backend folder you can run migrations and seeding scripts (see [appendices/db-schema.md](#)). If your dataset changes a lot during development, prefer a reset workflow to ensure schema + seed data are consistent.

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
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Page won't load / blank screen	Frontend dev server not running; JS e...	Start frontend, open browser devtools...
API requests fail with ERR_CONNECTION	Backend not running or wrong port	Start backend (or Docker Compose); co...
Browser shows CORS error	CORS_ORIGIN / CLIENT_URL mismatch	Ensure backend CORS origin matches th...
?No disease found.? even though data ...	Empty DB; seed not applied; filters t...	Run migrations + seed; retry with no ...
Swagger (/api-docs) not loading	Backend down; reverse proxy misconfig...	Confirm backend is running and try ht...
DB errors on startup (Prisma connection)	DATABASE_URL wrong; DB container not	Verify Postgres container health, the...
Redis connection errors	Redis container not running; wrong ho...	In Docker Compose, Redis host is typi...

Error Messages

Error Code/Message	Meaning	How to Fix
{ "message": "No disease found." } (H...	Query returned zero results (not an e...	Relax filters/search, confirm DB is s...
{ "success": false, "message": "Bad R...	Invalid query/body parameters	Check parameter types/ranges (e.g., s...
{ "success": false, "message": "Resou...	Route does not exist	Confirm the path starts with /api/.....
{ "success": false, "message": "Inter...	Unhandled backend error	Check backend logs; in development yo...

Browser-Specific Issues

Browser	Known Issue	Workaround
Chrome	Aggressive caching during local dev	Hard refresh (Ctrl+F5) and disable ca...
Firefox	CORS errors are sometimes shown diffe...	Check the Network tab for the actual ...
Safari	Mixed-content restrictions when front...	Use consistent schemes locally (usual...
Edge	Same behavior as Chrome (Chromium)	Apply the same cache + devtools steps...

Getting Help

Self-Service Resources

- * [Documentation](#)
- * [API Reference](#)
- * Swagger/OpenAPI: <http://localhost:4000/api-docs> (when running locally)
- * Repository: <https://github.com/Doshirac/cvd-platform>

Contact Support

Channel	Response Time	Best For
GitHub Issues	Best-effort	Bug reports, feature requests, docume...

Reporting Bugs

When reporting a bug, please include:

- * **Steps to reproduce** - What actions lead to the issue?
- * **Expected behavior** - What should happen?
- * **Actual behavior** - What actually happens?
- * **Screenshots** - If applicable
- * **Browser/Device info** - Browser name, version, OS

Submit bug reports at: [Issue tracker URL or email]

Suggested issue tracker: - <https://github.com/Doshirac/cvd-platform/issues>